DOWNTOWN

Sunday
October 11, 2026
THE HINDU

ANNA NAGAR

Purasawalkam » Villivakkam » Kolathur » Nazarathpettai » Pattabiram » Maduravoyal » Koyambedu » Tiruverkadu » Puzhal » Kilpauk » Perambur » Mogappair
Avadi » Ayyapakkam » Tiruninravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoil » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills

'Anna Nagar association is wary of incomplete SWD work'

Citing flood risk, it has requested GCC to take measures to prevent water flow into the stormwater drains



The SWD construction site in Korattur. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

R. SUKUMAR

Federation of Anna Nagar Residents' Associations has raised the issue of sewage discharge into the stormwater drain which is being constructed from North Avenue Canal in Korattur to Padi junction to with the Villivakkam MLA, Aadhav Arjuna.

The federation also brought this issue to the notice of the Minister for Handlooms & Textiles,Vijay Balaji, who has been designated as the Minster in charge for monsoon preparedness for GCC's Zone 7 (Ambattur), Zone 8 (Anna Nagar) and Zone 9 (Teynampet) respectively during his inspection of the SWD work on September 11 in the presence of Anna Nagar MLA, V. K. Ramkumar, and the Regional Deputy Commissioner - Central, GCC, H. R. Koushik.

The project's aim

The aim of this ongoing SWD project, carried out by the Greater Chennai Corporation, is to mitigate floods in areas lying along Otteri Nullah, a water channel.

The channel begins at Anna Nagar and flows through Villivakkam, Kilpauk, Perambur, Jamalia and Pulianthope and drains into Buckingham Canal in Basin Bridge. Otteri Nullah carries water from North Avenue Canal which in turn receives surplus water from Ambattur lake and Ambattur region. As Otteri Nullah is narrow, water overflows in the areas it flows through. Hence, this project aims to reduce the water load in Otteri Nullah.

The project plans to achieve its objective by diverting water from North Avenue Canal bypassing Otteri Nullah and directly draining the water into Cooum river near Imayam Colony via Padi junction on Jawaharlal Nehru Main Road. In other words, the project aims to prevent the entry of water from North Avenue Canal to Otteri Nullah.

GCC is executing this project in two phases.

The phase one stretch is from North Avenue Canal in Korattur to Padi junction which is nearing completion.

The phase two stretch is from Padi junction to Cooum rive near Imayam Colony on Jawaharlal Nehru Main Road which is likely to begin after this north-east monsoon. Here, the Federation thanks GCC for accommodating its request for an additional drain from Wheels India gate on Jawaharlal Nehru Main Road to Padi junction.

Monsoon preparedness

As part of monsoon preparedness, the federation requested the GCC and elected representatives to prevent the entry of water into the phase one drain.

Until both the phases are complete, water should not be allowed to enter the phase one drain. The federation understands that GCC plans to pump and divert water into the Otteri Nullah from the new drain.

The federation sees the possibility of heavy flooding in Anna Nagar - East if this measure is taken. The federation requests GCC to revisit this plan.

'Protect the groundwater'

Yet another request is concreting of Otteri Nullah channel. Some stretches of the channel near Anna Nagar West have been concreted. The federation requested the authorities to concrete the entire channel to prevent groundwater contamination as Otteri Nullah carries water contaminated with sewage and industrial effluents.

R. Sukumar is the president of the Federation of Anna Nagar Residents' Associations



PREPARE FOR THE RAINY DAY

The wholesalers and retailers in this specific trade might be scattered, but George Town is still the place to visit ahead of the monsoon to stock up on rainwear and winterwear. Two legacy enterprises illustrate why this is Chennai's rainwear hub. **P4**



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'Villivakkam crematorium out of order for three months'





The crematorium near Padi flyover. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

D.BHASKERBABU

The chimney at the Greater Chennai Corporation-run crematorium on CTH Road in Villivakkam (near Padi flyover) got broken three months ago.

It has not been set right to this day.

It may be noted the other crematorium near Villivakkam railway station remains closed due to metro rail work. It was meant to be a temporary closure. It was closed three years ago. So residents were relying on the facility near Padi flyover. Now, this one is also not functioning. Therefore, residents have go to crematoriums in other places which is quite inconvenient. Further, the crematorium is poorly maintained. It is overrun with vegetation. On some days, the compound walls of the facility are



marred by posters of obituary advertisements.

The crematorium falls under Ward 94 in Zone 8 - Anna Nagar.

D.Bhaskerbabu is a resident of Villivakkam



Expedite restoration of footbridge at Park Station

R. RAGU



Commuters crossing the tracks at Park railway station. PHOTOS: RAGU R

The foot overbridge at Park Station was dismantled to facilitate Southern Railway's fourth line project between Chennai Beach and Egmore.

Though the project has been completed, the foot overbridge has not been restored. The continued absence of what was an extremely useful facility is keenly felt by commuters. Reportedly, the fabrication of the new footbridge is under way.

Meanwhile, commuters are "paying" for the delay going through the inconvenience of clambering over platforms after crossing the tracks. Needless to say that by crossing the tracks they are putting themselves in harm's way.

The footbridge was particularly helpful to those crossing over from Poonamallee Poonamallee High Road to Chintadripet. These commuters now cross the tracks and navigate a unpaved and uneven pathway accessed through a gate to get to Chintadripet.

Regulars to Park Station point out that two commuters recently had a fall while navigating this pathway at night.



'Trains run late on Chennai Central to Arakkonam route'

ANU NANDHANA M

Despite the renovation on Chennai Central-Arakkonam railway track got completed a month ago, EMU trains on Chennai Central - Arakkonam line continue to run late. They do not stick to the time schedule. Further, there is no announcement of the delay at the stations.

It may be noted around 50 train services were temporarily suspended on Chennai Central - Gummudipoondi line and a few other lines about a year ago citing track maintenance and other works.

Those trains also have not been restored to this day. This is causing considerable inconvenience to passengers, especially for office-goers and college students. Further, trains are overcrowded during peak hours. Some commuters resort to footboard travelling. Southern Railway should address this issue at the earliest.

Anu Nandhana M is resident of Avadi



A sub-urban train of Chennai Central - Arakkonam line at Chennai Central railway station. FILE PHOTO

THE HINDU GROUP

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Prepare for the rainy day

The wholesalers and retailers in this specific trade might be scattered, but George Town is still the place to visit ahead of the monsoon to stock up on rainwear and winterwear. Two legacy enterprises illustrate why this is Chennai's rainwear hub

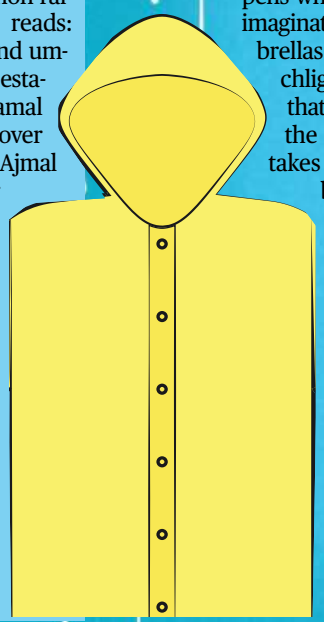
LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

In George Town, trades have a vice-like grip on streets, owning them to the point of suffocation. Every street name board bears an unwritten promise to meet an overwhelming existential need. If bags are your ticket to retail therapy, head to Stringer Street. Seeking to announce a new life chapter with the printing of a wedding card? Anderson Street holds out an invitation to you to visit it. Want to indulge your sartorial addiction? Saunter into Godown Street. Looking to be stocked up on rainwear ahead of the monsoon? No pat answer there; that requires the directory of George Town to be consulted.

Rainwear shopping in George Town is spatially undefined, but George Town is the best place in town to scour for it. Wholesalers and retailers of raincoats and umbrellas and woollen winterwear (you read that right, exclusive winter wear shopping in Chennai) are scattered across the landscape. They are found on NSC Bose Road, separated by shops ruled by other trades; on Malayaperumal Street and Rattan Bazaar Road. The term "raingear" presupposes seasonality; and the enterprises, both wholesale and retail, pair them with an all-season product or two to keep the cash register ringing through the year.

On Malayaperumal Street, New Jothi Stores LLP does this kind of pairing to stay afloat on a non-rainy day. The product line reads: bags, luggages, raincoats and umbrellas. The enterprise was established in 1968 by Hajji Jamal Mohideen, who handed over the baton to his sons, Hajji Ajmal Khan and Hajji Mujibur Rahman. And the baton is now lodged with the founder's grandsons, Muhammed Mohideen and his cousin Muhammed Sirajudeen. The store at George Town boasts massive square-footage, and is present in other locations, not as outlets but manufacturing units. There is a unit in Mint Street, another in Athipet and two others in Maharashtra, each one dedicated to the manufacture of specific product. In addition, there is sourcing from elsewhere which includes importing. The shelves at New Jothi Stores offer a glimpse of what happens when necessity meets a little imagination. From traditional umbrellas to reversible ones, torchlight umbrellas and designs that change colour when wet, the shop's promise of variety takes centre stage. While the bags and luggages segment is on an even keel through the year, the one involving raincoats and umbrellas wax and wane depending on the monsoon and its intensity. Copious rains means brisk business. But New Jothi Stores does not chase only the North East Monsoon for business, but the South West Monsoon as well. As a wholesaler, its brings Kerala and Karnataka into the picture supplying raincoats and umbrellas to retailers out there, and what emerges is a semblance of an all-year business.

Besides, with a touch of creativity and customisation, a seasonal project such as the umbrella is made attractive when the skies are clear. Mohideen points out that umbrellas made in the colours of a political party are a hit through the year. So, there are umbrellas that cover all parties on the political spectrum, enabling party cadres to display their allegiance.



Shopping spots

Streets close to Flower Bazaar sport shops selling monsoon kit, NSC Bose Road has a number of them including Ebrahim Currim & Sons, the iconic manufatiurer and seller of Stag umbrellas. There is MS Rahim Stores for raincoats. On Malayaperumal Street, there is New Jothi Stores. On Mangammal Street, there is Hindustan Industries. On Rattan Bazaar Road, there is Joonus Sait & Sons.

Where 'winter' never ends

All through the year, winter hovers over one address at Ratan Bazaar Road in George Town. Joonus Sait & Sons, established in 1905, sells rainwear and woollen winterwear in good old, often searing-hot Chennai, operating in bustling Ratan Bazaar. The patriarch of the family, Usman Sait defends the decision taken by his forbear several "winters" ago and followed by successive generations. The winterwear is not just for those navigating a narrow band of winter months in Chennai, but also for those travelling abroad to coordinates where winter defines the climate more than any other season. In a globalised economy, a massive number of people go abroad for studies and work and vacations (and of course, there are also cooler places in India to travel to), remarks Usman, and they know "there is a Joonus Sait & Sons". That confidence bordering on chutzpah has worked for the family and the business, which has put out branches, one in Purasaiwalkam and another in Adyar. Usman manages the legacy enterprise with the support of his wife Zulekha and sons Naumaan Sait and Safwaan Sait.

The enterprise's service extends to helping customers choose according to their destination and travel duration and also educating them on preserving the items. Bulk order for corporate clients is a strong feature of the business. Its woollen wear, including brands such as Monte Carlo, are sourced from Ludhiana. For Usman, the store is also a childhood memory. He recalls accompanying his father after school, wondering why he had to spend the afternoon there. The lessons he absorbed however became his own principles, passed down to his sons. Legacy is the operative word. Usman speaks wistfully of the golden days when his father was his mentor in the trade. He speaks with equal fondness of the here and now, with a special softness reserved for his four granddaughters, who visit the store and learn the business from him. He adds that they will take the legacy forward. Usman's son Naumaan notes that the enterprise treats every client as a part of the legacy.

Calls for new transformers intensify

LIFFY THOMAS

For Bilkhis Sait, "overload", "changeover" and "low voltage" are everyday terminology. A resident of Marshalls Road in Egmore for the last three decades, Bilkhis notes unscheduled power cuts have become a daily feature in her locality.

"Sometimes, the outage lasts a few hours. At times power goes off in all the three phases," says Bilkhis.

Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited (TNPDCL) technicians do attend to complaints raised through the helpline number. "They replace the cable and power is restored but the same issue resurfaces. We have not got a long-term solution," says the French language trainer who wants the transformer in the neighbourhood upgraded.

Residents of Tarapore Avenue in Harrington Road find themselves dealing with the same issue. And they seek the same solution: replacement of the existing transformer. Their latest representation is a little over a month old. For now, the department has provided thicker wires so the frequent power outages have almost reduced.

With independent houses giving way to apartment complexes and commercial buildings in many areas, the rusty transformer is not able to take the load anymore. Increasing power demands from houses and offices using heavy electrical appliances, and climate change are adding to the stress on the neighbourhood distribution transformers.

So, how is TNPDCL addressing the increasing electricity demand and growing renewable energy penetration?

Upgrading the load capacity of an existing transformer, adding new transformers and bifurcating the load supply are some common measures initiated by the electricity department, taken after many assessments and calculations.

In Chennai's residential areas, distribution transformers generally have a load capacity of 100 kVA, 250 kVA and 500 kVA, depending on the number of people the utility is catering to. But rising load is one of the major reasons for transformers failing.

Excess load?

According to officials, transformers have an average lifespan of 20 years but this could vary depending on how well they are maintained. Factors such as natural calamities, manufacturing defects, ageing, short circuits and other unexpected reasons would require these electrical equipments to be replaced more often. Many defunct transformers have to be replaced because of overload and lighting.

TNPDCL is expected to assess areas where complaints are common and initiate improvement measures. A consumer may not know the capacity of the transformer or the distribution network, so the executive engineer for the area should be first informed about such power-related complaints. The engineer has to justify the electricity needs and suggest whether it can do with an upgrade or a new utility transformer is required.

"As the load pattern is different in the morning and evening, the transformer load is measured by our field staff based on a set of parameters. When the transformer reaches more than 80% load then we decide on an upgrade or a new set up, which is done through a measuring tool. Electricity feeders are also remotely monitored by the control centre," says a senior engineer.

TNPDCL field staff prepares and submits an estimate of areas needing a new transformer, almost every month, to submit it to the head office for approval. The time to process a tender is usually three to four months.

Getting ROW clearance

A senior official says one of the biggest hurdles they face is getting right of way (ROW) clearance or permission to instal an electricity transformer in an area.

"Nobody wants a transformer in front of their house or the stay resting on their premises, so this delays the process. We scout for a public space as maintenance work can be taken up easily at such spots," says the official.

The Superintendent Engineer has the power to sanction a transformer. "If a transformer is badly needed in an area then in two-three months time it is sanctioned," says the official.

The "citizen charter" also insists that if the work involves placing or shifting a transformer structure then 90 days is the timeline followed as per the standards of performance for electricity distribution.

Help at hand

Raise a complaint on Minnagam (9498794987) mentioning the frequency of power cuts or other load-related complaints

Write to the respective distribution region in your area seeking a review of the power load. Their contact numbers and mail IDs are on the website https://www.tnpdcl.org/en/tnpdcl/ reach-us/contact-information



With power demands having increased significantly over the years, many residential areas seek a new transformer to prevent overloading

Adopt a holistic approach

Meeting the growing electricity demand of households requires more than just upgrading distribution transformers. Distribution companies (DISCOMs) that supply electricity to consumers in a state need to adopt a holistic approach that combines demand-side management, energy efficiency, timely infrastructure augmentation, and better asset management.

Here are suggestions by Rishu Garg, senior policy specialist working in the Energy and Power sector at CSTEP.

Demand-response programmes: DISCOMs can encourage households to shift flexible electricity consumption, such as operating washing machines and water heaters, away from peak-demand hours through suitable incentives. This can help flatten peak demand, ease pressure on local distribution networks, and defer the need for some infrastructure upgrades.

Promote energy-efficient appliances: wider adoption of energy-efficient air conditioners, refrigerators, water heaters, and other household appliances can reduce overall electricity consumption and limit the growth of peak demand. Targeted incentives, consumer awareness, and easier access to efficient appliances can help accelerate adoption.

Strengthen distribution infrastructure and expedite transformer upgrades: DISCOMs should make effective use of schemes such as the Revamped Distribution Sector Scheme (RDSS) to augment distribution infrastructure in areas experiencing rapid growth in household demand. Equally important are streamlined approval processes, clear timelines, and proactive identification of overloaded distribution transformers to ensure that capacity upgrades are completed before they become critical. However, this should be done after conducting feasibility studies based on load growth.

Adopt distribution asset lifecycle management systems: DISCOMs should invest in digital systems to monitor transformer loading, asset health, maintenance requirements, and failure risks.

Women receive ‘Golden Wings’

An initiative by Chennai-based Care Earth Trust is training local women in Vedanthangal and Unamancheri to identify birds, lead nature walks and earn a livelihood while spreading biodiversity awareness

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

Until recently, for some of the women living around Vedanthangal, the birds they saw every day were simply part of the landscape. Today, they are part of their life, even the sounds of these avians being familiar to these women’s now-trained ears. That transformation was engineered by a nature-guide training programme from Chennai-based Care Earth Trust.

With the two-fold objective of increasing biodiversity awareness and providing livelihood opportunities, the programme began with women and young people from around Vedanthangal, training them in bird identification, wetland ecology, identification of trees butterflies, and communication skills. After months of classroom lessons and practical sessions, a group of eight trained participants have come together as ‘Golden Wings’ and are now conducting guided walks at Vedanthangal.

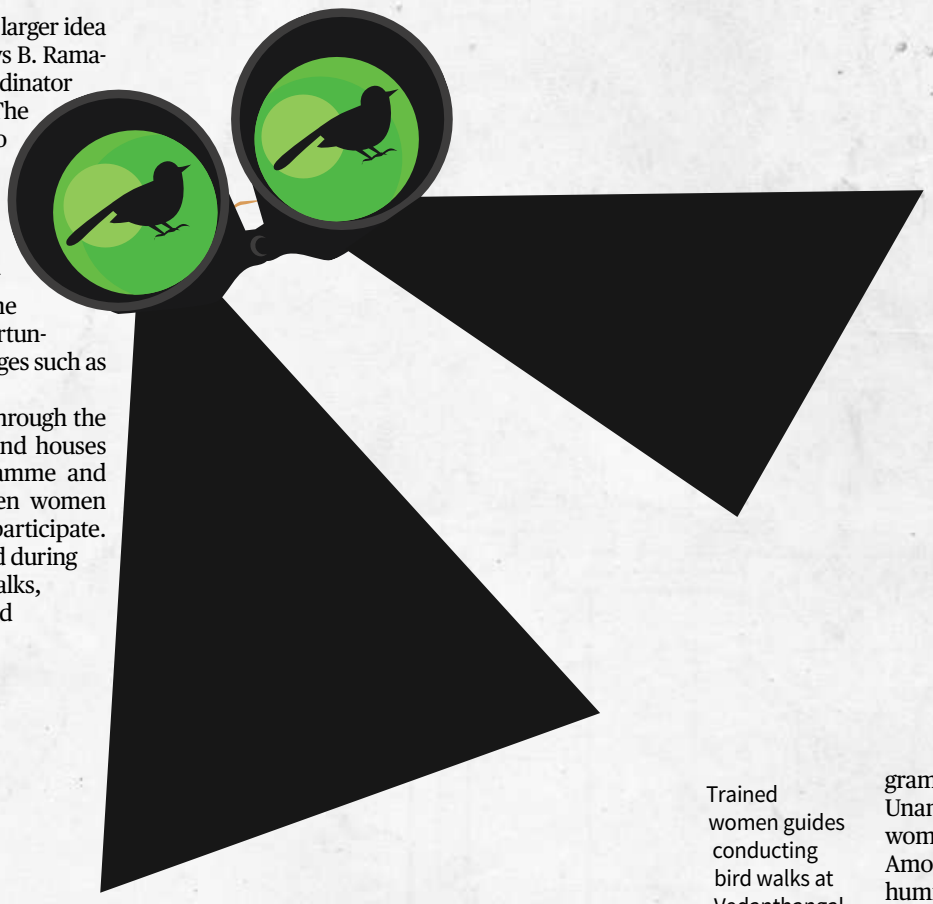
Vedanthangal resident S. Kalaiselvi Srinivasan, now a Golden Wings guide, says the work has given her an income opportunity as well as improved her communication skills.

For Subathirai D, however, the journey began with skepticism from those around her. When she first started attending the training, women in her neighbourhood questioned why she was spending her time on it. To them, learning about birds and nature seemed unnecessary, especially when she could be spending that time on household responsibilities or other work. But that perception began to change when Subathirai returned from the training and started earning through nature walks.

This is precisely the larger idea behind the project, says B. Ramamoorthy, Project Coordinator at Care Earth Trust. The organisation wanted to address two issues at once: the limited awareness among local communities about the biodiversity around them and the lack of livelihood opportunities for women in villages such as Vedanthangal.

The team worked through the panchayat, went around houses to explain the programme and spoke to families when women were hesitant to participate. Childcare was arranged during training and nature walks, food was provided, and the women themselves suggested Sundays as the most convenient day for classes.

The initial training involved classroom sessions using colour printouts and presentations to teach the participants about different birds, trees and butterflies. They then moved to practical walks, where they learnt to identify birds through their appearance and calls and understand local and native trees and their uses. They were also taken on a week-long exposure visit to Thattekad in Kerala to learn about forest biodiversity and migratory birds. The training did not stop with bird identification. The women were taught spoken English, people management and social-media skills.



Trained women guides conducting bird walks at Vedanthangal.

For Anjana Venkatesan, Programme Manager - Policy Research at Care Earth Trust, the project is about creating a connection between local women and the ecotourism circuit while drawing attention to the biodiversity outside Chennai. “Connecting them to the local kind of ecotourism circuit is a win-win for both of us,” she said. She also wants to challenge the perception that people have to travel to the Western Ghats to experience rich bird diversity. “Right in the outskirts of Chennai, you have these pockets with our existing forests and existing wetlands,” she said, adding that some of these areas record around 70 bird species during the migratory season.

The next phase of the programme is now taking shape in Unamancheri, Vandalur, where women are undergoing training. Among them is 29-year-old Madhumitha S., a B.Sc graduate who works in medical coding. Originally from Medavakkam, she moved to Unamancheri after marriage and has been attending the Sunday classes for around two months.

For Madhumitha, the training has meant discovering a side of the place she now calls home. Before joining the programme, she was familiar mainly with common birds. The classes introduced her to a much wider range of birds, trees, butterflies and other species.

Madhumitha is now learning how to handle tourists, engage them and conduct nature walks. She plans to continue her medical-coding job during the week and take up nature walks on weekends after completing her training.

Giving old school benches a fresh look

Thuvakkam invites volunteers for the first drive of this kind happening on October 17 at a government school in Ambattur



Grime, pencil and pen marks and splatter of paints on school benches are more than a visual eyesore. Their appearance can affect the learning environment in a classroom.

Thuvakkam is starting "School Benches Revamp – Paint with Purpose" initiative to transform old and faded school benches into bright and welcoming furniture for students. They are looking for volunteers who are willing to clean and paint benches in government and government-aided institutions across Chennai. Paint and other supplies needed to spruce up the classroom benches will be provided by the NGO.

The first such drive will be held at a government school in Ambattur on October 17; 9.30 a.m. to 11 a.m.

To volunteer for such drives, register by contacting Kodama Durga Prasad at 9884403762

Charging station in Poonamallee

Zappang Charging Stations has opened an electric vehicle (EV) charging station at Motel Highway in Poonamallee.

The station features a 60 kW DC fast-charging facility, designed to provide convenient charging for EV users. Focused on clean energy and sustainable transportation, Zappang aims to make EV charging more accessible for motorists. The facility promotes a greener driving experience and encourages the transition towards environmentally friendly mobility solutions.

For location details and inquiries, contact 95666 83952.

Yaavarum photography contest receives good response



Yaavarum Wildlife Photography Contest, organised by Rotary Club of Chennai Crown, witnessed around 300 participants from across India. According to a press release, the contest was held for those with hearing impairment.

The felicitation ceremony was held last week at Arignar Anna Zoological Park, Vandalur.

The contest was conducted in association with Madras Photobloggers and the Deaf Artist Collective.

The first prize of ₹5,000 was awarded to Danial, while Sabari won the second prize of ₹3,000. Venkatesh and John Reegan received the first and second runner-up prizes, respectively, with each receiving ₹1,000. The top 10 entries were also recognised at the ceremony. Shriram Duvvuri, district governor, Rotary International District 3233 was the chief guest. He felicitated the winners along with Anil Kumar of the Tamil Nadu Forest Department.

The event also featured an awareness programme on wildlife for students of Soundarapandi Suppamma Higher Secondary School. Experts from Arignar Anna Zoological Park shared insights on wildlife and conservation, encouraging students to appreciate and protect nature. Besides, a drawing contest was held for the school students.

Sign language interpretation was provided to make the programme accessible to the hearing-impaired, adds the release.

CM launches 'Dream Olympics'



Ishari K. Ganesh, president, Tamil Nadu Olympic Association, and founder-chancellor, Vels University, welcomed C. Joseph Vijay, Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, at The Leela Palace recently.

The CM launched the 'Dream Olympics' initiative and felicitated Tamil Nadu's Asian Games and chess olympiad medal winners at the event organised by Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu (SDAT).

Aadhav Arjuna, State Minister for Sports Development, and prominent sportspersons were among those who took part in the event.

Property expo in Pallavaram, Urapakkam

Today is the final day of ARK Eventz Property Expo 2026. The event is being held at Arul Murugan Towers, 200 Feet Radial Road, Old Pallavaram, and at Swapna Thirumana Mandapam, GST Road, Urapakkam; 10 a.m. to 7 p.m.

At the expo, prospective buyers can explore a wide range of property options, including apartments, villas, plots, and investment opportunities. Buyers can meet builders and developers, compare properties, and discover attractive options, said a release.

For registration and details, visit www.arkeventz.com or call 94444 56087.

Clown festival concludes today

Today is the last day of the International Clown Festival 2026 happening at Sir Mutha auditorium in Chetpet with shows scheduled at 3 p.m. and 7 p.m.

The International Clown Festival is a celebration of the universal language of laughter, bringing together the art and craft of professional clowning with the energy of live theatre. Designed as a family-friendly experience, the festival combines visual comedy, physical performance, music, juggling, and audience interaction to create a show that can be enjoyed by children and adults alike, said a press release.

The festival is curated and produced by Martin Flubber D'Souza, an award-winning international clown, former Vice President of the World Clown Association.



Challani Jewellery exhibition open today at Taj Connemara



Challani Jewellery Mart's Challani's Jewelverse –Season 1, a grand showcase of exquisite jewellery, commenced on October 9 at Taj Connemara, under the leadership of Jayanthilal Challani, founder and chairman of Challani Jewellery Mart.The exhibition was inaugurated by Adityaram, founder and chairman of the Adityaram Group who formally opened the event by cutting the ribbon and lighting the traditional ceremonial lamp. According to a press release, the exhibition brings together an extensive collection of fine jewellery, featuring gold, diamonds, Polki, rose-cut diamonds and coloured gemstones under one roof. Combining traditional craftsmanship with contemporary designs, the showcase offers visitors an opportunity to explore a diverse range of distinctive jewellery collections.

Speaking to the media after the inauguration, Adityaram expressed his appreciation for the collection on display. "I have visited several jewellery exhibitions, but the variety of collections showcased here is truly remarkable. What stands out is the range of designs available not only for women but also for men, with distinctive pieces that are visually appealing," he said.

Jayanthilal Challani said although Challani Jewellery Mart has several branches, our objective is to bring different categories of jewellery together in one place, offering customers a comprehensive shopping experience. This exhibition features an exclusive selection of gold, diamond, Polki, rose-cut and coloured gemstone jewellery. The inaugural event witnessed the participation of several prominent personalities, including Thangamalar Jagannath and Dr. Vimala Rani Britto, along with other distinguished guests and jewellery enthusiasts. Visitors were seen exploring the collections with considerable interest.

Challani's Jewelverse - Season 1 is being held from October 9 to 11 (between 10:00 a.m. and 9:00 p.m.)

Venue: Taj Connemara, Binny Road, Near Spencer Plaza

A tall Kolu display at SPR City from October 11 to 20

SPR City in Perambur is featuring a 45-ft-tall kolu display taking tradition to new heights this Navaratri. According to a press release, the display, which will be 45 feet high, will feature over 4,500 kolu dolls, thereby staking a claim to a world record. SPR City will unveil a grand 10-day Kolu celebration on October 11 and the exhibition will be on till October 20.

Velammal Nexus felicitates Vithya Ramraj, Nehpal Singh



Velammal Nexus felicitated athlete Vithya Ramraj, who bagged three medals at the Asian Games, and her coach, Nehpal Singh. The felicitation ceremony was hosted by Velammal Vidyalaya in Avadi.

Vithya Ramraj, her mother Meena, and Nephal Singh were welcomed with a beautifully decorated chariot procession, flower garlands, and traditional ceremonial honours, creating an atmosphere of pride and celebration across the campus. As a mark of appreciation, Velammal Nexus presented a car each to Vithya Ramraj and Nephal Singh, said a release.

M.V. M. Velmohan, correspondent, Velammal Nexus, took part. Vithya's journey from rigorous training to winning medals at the Asian Games inspires thousands of young students aspiring to excel in sports, added the release.



Impressive performance by Saveetha college students in sports meet



Saveetha Dental College Sports Club participated in ALTIUS'26, an intercollegiate medical and dental sports meet, organised by Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education & Research in Porur recently.

According to a press release, Saveetha Dental College team delivered an impressive performance. students won silver, gold, and bronze in the long jump. The college also won the volleyball tournament, adds the release.

In cricket, a student of the college won the "best bowler" title.

The kho kho team of Saveetha Dental College Sports Club securing the runner-up place in De Sportivous 4.0, another inter-college sports event, organized by Saveetha College of Occupational Therapy, held recently at Saveetha Medical College, Thandalam.

The teams were appreciated by the chancellor of Saveetha University, Dr. N. M Veeraiyan, adds the press release.

